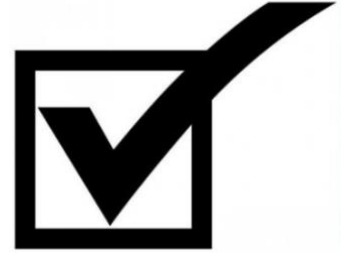




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

NATIONAL 2022

PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

NATIONAL PRELIMINARY SCENARIO KEY:

After taking an extended year-long maternity leave, Terri has returned to her job as the Accountant at Digital Solutions, a small, family-owned and operated retail technology chain. As she reviews the financial records for the period she was on leave, she notices various irregularities which suggest that the company has been reporting less income than they actually made. Terri approaches the company owner, Brad, who admits to altering the financial records as a result of unexpected family medical bills. Although Brad assures Terri that this situation will not happen again now that she is back and monitoring the records, he also states that the company is not financially able to pay any penalties or back taxes. If the true earned revenue is reported to the appropriate tax authorities, Digital Solutions may have to reduce staff and possibly close its doors for good. If she does not report the fraudulent activity, she could possibly lose her license.

- What company ethics policies should Terri consider before making her decision?
- How will the company be impacted based on her decision?
- What procedures should be implemented to reduce the potential for fraud in the future?
- Is having an ethical conflict with the company and/or the owner's fraudulent activities a sign Terri should leave the company?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Honesty is critical in the response.
- Open communication is conducting professional business with transparency and dual freedom to exchange information.
- Equal opportunities ensure those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Integrity is holding to your principles even when it would be easier or more profitable to compromise them.
- With good communication skills, you can convey your perspective even in the most uncomfortable of situations.

- Neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness.
- Good business ethics require that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside of the business.
- Ethical behavior more often than not trickles down from the top. If the leaders of an organization practice good business ethics, chances are better that employees will follow the example.
- Business ethics ensure that the organization abides by the law of the land.
- Companies that are involved in scandals and known for unsavory business practices are viewed by the public with much skepticism.
- Personal values versus company profits are often a source of conflict as are dilemmas triggered by breaches of confidentiality, personal bias, or illegal activity.